

Healthy Living 9

A discussion-based approach to
building healthy relationships

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Getting From Here to There

Outcomes

Students will be expected to:

- 9.13 analyze the role of alcohol in the decision-making process related to increased risk of unintended pregnancies, STIs, impaired driving and injury.
- 9.14 practice speaking about concerns regarding substance use and gambling in self or others.

Note

- The leading cause of death for 15-25 year olds in Canada is motor vehicle accidents and alcohol is involved in 50% of those. 87% of the drivers in these fatal accidents are male. Youth 15-25 are both the least likely to drive after drinking and the most likely to die when they do. More than double (4% to 9%) the number of youth who report having driven drunk have reported driving high (Chamberlain & Soloman, 2006).

Topic

Impaired driving, decision-making

Materials

- Sets of 5-6 chairs
- 2 pairs of pyjama pants

Background

- Arrange chairs in 4 rectangular groups of 5 or 6, as if cars at a 4 way stop.
- Assign students to “cars” so that all seats are filled. Improvise extra spaces using the trunk and/or two in the front seat if needed.
- Check in question: What is something you’re looking forward to doing in the next 6 months?

Activity A

Begin by describing a scenario using one of the cars. Assign a driver who is going home after a few drinks at 3 a.m. with a car full of friends. There is a crash. Describe the injuries of each individual in the car, including head injury, spinal cord injury and broken bones. The driver walks away from the scene.

Assign one of the cars, including the car previously used for the injuries scenario, to each of the following role plays:

- Passengers are loud and obnoxious to the point they irritate and distract the driver (passengers could be fighting, singing loudly, showing phone to the driver, the driver could be texting). Role-play this for 30 seconds and encourage the driver to find a way to end the distractions however s/he can.
- The second car is full of people who have been drinking, including the driver. Though the driver is the least drunk (having only had a couple of beers) s/he is drowsy, but still offers to drive his/her friends home. Role-play this for 30 seconds.

Getting From Here to There

Ask the students who thinks that this car is less risky, more risky, and just the same as the first car. Be sure to ask questions around any rationalizations of the risks being taken that come up.

- The third car is full of people who have been using marijuana. Assure students that the driver drives high all the time and has never had a problem. Role play this for 30 seconds.

Ask students again if this is less risky, more risky, or just the same as the previous cars. Escalate the stakes of the marijuana car: Ask everyone who was OK with a high driver to sit in the “car.” Change the situation to a high pilot and ask whether they will stay in the plane; those that would not return to the circle.

Continue to escalate for the remaining students: would they allow a high surgeon to operate on them? Would they allow a driver who was high to drive their newborn to an important appointment? Ask the students to explain their rationale.

- The fourth car is full of a young family on the way to hockey practice. All of them are doing everything correctly; seat belts, eyes on the road, not distracting the driver, etc. Ask students to assess the risk to this family given that the other 3 cars are on the road around them.

The fourth car could also be driven by someone impaired on a prescription drug. You should emphasize prescription drugs are medicine. Doctors give them to patients who are sick or injured. If you’re not sick or injured and take a prescription drug it can hurt you. The drug can lead to a dependence or addiction, it can increase your chances of an injury, and in some cases it can kill you. They’re especially harmful when mixed with other drugs, like alcohol. For the driver of a vehicle taking a prescription drug the impact can be unpredictable – the drug could make the driver sleepy or extremely anxious – and so should be avoided.

Discussion

After each scenario, ask the passengers to decide whether they would be comfortable accepting a ride in the car. Students who decide to leave can move back to the circle.

Extensions

- Ask students to identify community resources that chronically impaired drivers can access.
- Discuss potential links between distracted driving and car-pedestrian collisions.

Getting From Here to There

Note

You are not expected to give a detailed explanation of gender identity and/or expression in this class. The goal is to explain the groups will be based on shared experiences. You will have the opportunity to discuss gender in more detail once the groups have been established.

For more information on gender, see the Facilitator's Guide or visit The Youth Project website at www.youthproject.ns.ca.

References

Chamberlain, E., & Soloman, R. (2006, July 7). *Youth and Impaired Driving in Canada: Opportunities for Progress*. Retrieved from MADD Canada website: www.madd.ca/english/research/youth_and_impaired_driving_may_2006.pdf

Splitting into Groups

The following is a guide to explain splitting the class into the groups that will be meeting in the following weeks.

Draw two boxes on the whiteboard labelled “masculine” and “feminine.”

“You might feel like you belong in one of these little boxes, somewhere between them, or outside the board entirely. You’re the expert on your own identity. But the assumptions we make about people in general are usually based on what’s inside these little boxes.”

- Using a different colour marker, draw a handful of arrows coming out of each box.

“You probably know what some of these assumptions are: a baby’s room should be either pink or blue; ‘gifts for him’ are hammers or wallets and ‘gifts for her’ are earrings or necklaces.

“We’re concerned as these assumptions add up, they lead to expectations you might feel pressure to live up to. You probably already know some of these too: some expectations from this box are that you shouldn’t cry, or that you shouldn’t ask for help; some expectations from this box are that you’re too emotional or that you should look good all the time.”

- Ask for more expectations of masculinity and femininity.

“We’re also concerned the pressure to live up to these broad expectations affect the way you think about important issues: things like sex, body image or healthy relationships. We want to make it easier to talk about these issues, so the next time we meet, we’re going to break into two groups: one group will focus on how the expectations of masculinity relate to your health, and the other group will focus on how the expectations of femininity relate to your health. You may not feel all the same pressures in the same way, but we’ve found having groups that share some of these pressures have an easier time talking about them.

“So you have until next week to decide the group that fits you best: masculinity or femininity. If you find out the group you chose isn’t the best fit, you can try the other group.”

Trust and Community Standards

Topic

Communication, safety

Outcomes

No specific outcome for this activity. This session is to lay the foundation of trust and expectations for the group.

Materials

- Soft objects (balls, stuffed animals)
- Flipchart paper
- Markers
- Trust-building activities (see appendix)

Background

- This session will introduce the discussion-style classroom, including check-ins and sitting in a circle. The group will also develop a list of community standards that will help them work best together.
- Have chairs arranged in a circle before the students arrive.

Activity

Explain you'll be starting each session with a check-in question and ending with a check-out question as a way to get to know, and receive feedback from, the students. Remind students that along with the check-in question, you want them to tell the group their preferred name and pronoun. Suggested check-in question: What's something important you want the group to know about you?

Tell the group that this session will be spent getting to know each other and figuring out the best way to work together.

The first activity is "Group Juggle." Ask everyone to stand in a circle with their hands up and palms facing in the circle. Explain that you'll be tossing a ball or soft object through the circle until everyone has a turn. Each person will say the name of the person they're throwing to, and lower their hands after they've caught and thrown the ball. The activity ends when the ball comes back to the facilitator. Ask everyone to remember who they threw the ball to.

Repeat the activity, this time adding in a second ball/object partway through. Repeat again, adding as many objects as you can. Start from the beginning if someone drops or isn't able to catch the ball.

Trust and Community Standards

Extensions

See appendix for other trust-building activities.

Take note of who comes across as a leader or creative thinker.

When finished, ask the group what allowed them to succeed.

Spread out among the room. Ask everyone to think of a favourite place in the world. Then ask the group to think of the floor as a map of the world, and without talking, go to their favourite place on the map. Once everyone has found a place, ask them to say where they are and why it makes sense.

The map won't make sense: Australia might be next to Newfoundland. Ask the group to identify what would have made the process easier. They will likely suggest things like figuring out where North is, or having a reference point.

Bring everyone back into the circle. Explain without a set of standards, it's like using a map without knowing which way is North. Ask the group to come up with standards that will help them work best together. Let them know you might suggest some too. Write down their suggestions on the flip chart paper.

Suggest the following standards if the group doesn't come up with them on their own: confidentiality, being open to try new things, being open to other opinions, protecting the voice of others in the room. Be sure to explain to the group that the facilitator will be held to these standards as well, and ask them to suggest anything a facilitator could do to help with trust or add to these group sessions.

When the group has reached consensus on the standards, let them know you'll be periodically checking in to see how they think the group is living up to the standards.

Check-out: Do you think we can follow the community standards through the semester? (Thumbs up or thumbs down). Revisit the map question and ask the group to explain why they chose the place they did as their favorite place in the world, and if they have been there before.

Expectations of Masculinity

Outcomes

Students will be expected to:

- 9.15 examine the negative impact of stereotyping and stigma upon help-seeking behaviour.

Topic

Masculinity, help-seeking behaviour

Materials

- A large, empty backpack
- 15+ cans or other small weights
- Markers
- Pieces of paper with expectations of masculinity (see Appendix)
- Blank paper

Background

- Clear an area of the room and create a circle of chairs.
- Pile cans/weights on the floor.
- Ask one volunteer to wear the backpack and one to fill it during the activity.

Activity

Check in: Ask students to introduce themselves in the most manly voice they can muster.

Explain to the class that guys growing up in Nova Scotia are under pressure to act a certain way; to be masculine and “be” a certain way as a man. Have a volunteer name each expectation and ask the students if they agree that some guys might feel this. Add a weight to the bag if they agree. Add multiple cans/weights for those expectations that are validated strongly. Allow the class to contribute their own expectations.

Ask the backpack wearer periodically to do a lap of the circle and if they would mind carrying that weight around all day. At the end of the exercise the backpack should be full.

Let others try the backpack so they can get a feel for how heavy it is.

Spread the expectations out on the floor and ask the students, if they feel comfortable, to walk around and place check marks on the expectations that

Expectations of Men

they feel themselves one or two at a time.

Discussion

- How could these expectations be dangerous to your physical health?
- How could these expectations affect your mental health?
- Explain that these expectations act as a script that tells us what to say and how to act to be a man.
- What would someone be like if he lived up to all of these expectations? Would you want to hang out with him?
Where do we learn this script? Which of your role models is teaching it to you?
- Did the voices you used during the check in make you a better man or is it more about what you use your voice to do (standing up for others, etc.)?
- Are you doing the same thing (pretending) when you feel pressured to live up to these expectations?

Check-out: Imagine you're going to have a child. If you could get rid of just one of these expectations before your son has to deal with it, which would it be?

Note

Traditional masculinity promotes unhelpful coping strategies like not expressing emotion or seeking help (Moller-Leimkuhler, 2003). By the time they reach adolescence most boys feel that they are expected to play a traditionally masculine role to some extent. This contributes to many boys' risky behaviours and also contributes to why suicide rates are three times higher for men than for women (Statistics Canada, 2012).

Extensions

Refer back to “the script” in future activities to reinforce the idea that students may be playing into some of these expectations.

References

- Suicide rates: An overview.* (2012). Retrieved from Statistics Canada website: <http://www.statcan.gc.ca/pub/82-624-x/2012001/article/11696-eng.htm>
- Moller-Leimkuhler, A. M. (2003). The gender gap in suicide and premature death or: why are men so vulnerable? *European Archives of Psychiatry and Clinical Neurosciences*, 253, 1-8.

Angels & Demons

Outcomes

Students will be expected to:

- 9.1 analyze their health needs in times of change and apply strategies that enhance their capacity to manage change in their lives.

Topic

Safety, decision making

Background

- Arrange chairs in two circles or separate spaces

Materials

- Safety scenarios (see appendix)
- Chart Paper
- Markers

Activity

Check-in: Describe a situation you might encounter in the next year that would make you feel unsafe.

Explain to the students that we are going to talk about safety as youth, when trying new things and when doing things more independently.

Read the class the Angels & Demons scenario, and explain that, while in this case you are in the know about what to expect, in real life you really don't know everything before going into a situation so they should expect the unexpected when thinking the scenario through.

The facilitator can choose, or ask the group, if they would like to divide the class into angels and demons or do the activity with the whole class as angels and then as demons.

If you're an Angel your mission is to think about what you can do together with the other Angels to make the environment healthier. What will you do to protect the health and safety of your friends? What can you do in advance or during the party to make it more safe?

If you're a Demon your mission is to make things worse! What will you do at the party that will have a negative impact on the health and safety of your friends?

Angels & Demons

How can you use/alter the information in the story to create a more risky environment?

Give the groups chart paper to record their ideas. They may list or draw their interventions on the paper. Inform them that they have some artistic license with the story and its details (e.g. the Angels may bring a box of condoms and the Demons may choose to alter the drinking game and make it happen in the water).

Share and discuss the changes that each side made.

Canvas the group for stories about parties they have been to or heard about and discuss how people acted to make the situation safer or less safe.

Discussion

- Would you want to be at the party as described?
- Is it possible to party safely?
- If you thought the Demons won, would you want your kids going to the same party in the future?
- Do you think you're going to be a Demon or an Angel this summer? When you hit high school? In your 20's?
- What influences you to behave as an angel or a demon when in a social setting with your friends? With people you don't know? With people you're attracted to?

Check-out: What does your community need to make people feel safer?

Extensions

Here are ways to modify the activity:

- Discuss how to respond to potential emergencies that may arise in this scenario (e.g. a friend drinks too much, someone passes out unexpectedly).
- Certify the class in Non-Violent Crisis Intervention, or provide information about the course.

Help-seeking Behaviour

Outcomes

Students will be expected to:

- 9.15 examine the negative impact of stereotyping upon help-seeking behaviour
- 9.2 recognize the warning signs of depressive disorders and the importance of seeking help for those disorders. (extension topics)

Topic

Help-seeking behaviour,

Materials

- “Help-seeking” slides (see Appendix)
- “Who would you ask for help” slides (see Appendix)
- “Help-seeking examples” slides (see Appendix)
- “Health issue” slides (optional, see Appendix)

Background

- Arrange chairs in a circle.
- Scatter help-seeking signs around the middle of the circle.

Activity

Check-in: How do you react when someone asks you if you need help with something?

Part One

Remind students that one of the expectations around masculinity is that guy's don't ask for help, and explain that this is a problem because guy's do have health issues that sometimes go undiagnosed and unsupported and that can make someone's life difficult. Go over the help-seeking categories with the group to clarify each one (NOTE: we should revisit the categories and make sure they make sense to facilitators).

Ask student volunteers individually to stand on the sign they feel most boys their age would identify with when they have a problem. You may wish to ask the students to explain why they picked their spot. Then ask them to move to the sign they feel they will identify with when they are 20 or 30 and faced with a problem. If the student is comfortable you may wish to ask them if the spot they chose is different from the spot they would choose today, for themselves.

Note

One of the expectations around masculinity is that boys and men do not ask for help. Seeking help can be stereotyped as a sign of weakness, so many health issues go unsupported. This lesson is designed to start a conversation about help-seeking and normalizing help-seeking behaviour.

Help-seeking Behaviour, cont.

Finally, ask them to move to where they would want their son or daughter to be, or which option they believe is healthiest.

Repeat with several volunteers, or every student who wishes to participate.

Next lay down the “Who you would ask for help” signs, and ask the students to identify who they would go see. If the student says it depends on the problem you have the option of laying down some additional slides that cover a range of health issues (depression, sexually transmitted disease, a relationship issue and drug misuse). Discuss the limits to how much each person could help (i.e. could a friend diagnose an STI?).

While the students are engaged in this activity there are several questions you can ask to probe for thoughts and feelings about help-seeking, including:

- Can you explain why where you stand may change depending on the problem?
- What are some problems that you can fix yourself? Can you think of any problem that you may not be able to fix (i.e. mental health)? What would you do?
- If you hurt your knee and were having difficulty playing your favourite sport, like hockey, how long would it take for you to ask for help? What might slow you down or stop you from asking?
- If you felt depressed and didn't feel like playing hockey anymore, how long would it take you to ask for help? Why is this different from asking for help with physical health problems?
- If your friend was having a problem, which sign would you want them to stand beside? What about your sister or brother?

Introduce the idea of “Back pocket people”- people in your life who you have “in your back pocket,” whom you can call on in a crisis. Ask if any of the students wish to volunteer who their back pocket people are. Remind students that they may have several back pocket people depending on the problem.

For many of the students, a visit to health professional may have only happened with a parent or other family member. If they have never gone to see a health professional on their own the class may wish to role play a visit so they know what to expect. Have some boys role play going to a walk-in clinic because they feel they may have an STI. You will need a patient, a receptionist, a doctor and possibly a friend. Remind students they don't have to tell a receptionist why they want to see a doctor (they could just say it's “private”). Let them know doctors are trained to help even if you don't know how to talk about the problem.

Extensions

Here are ways to modify the activity:

- Do further role plays including conversations with friends or family asking for help. For example, ask two students to play son and father and see how the father reacts when the son seeks support. Are they understanding?

Help-seeking Behaviour, cont.

Extensions

Here are ways to modify the activity:

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Part Two

Introduce the concept of a help-seeking reality check – an exercise that may help students figure out when they should ask for help.

Explain that you could put problems into three categories: small, medium and large problems.

Small problems can generally be solved on your own. They are minor problems that would rarely need help, and rarely distract you from daily life. Medium problems might be solved on your own, but they may also be impacting your daily life. They may become more serious and require help. Large problems are very difficult to manage on your own and need the support of friends, family and professionals. These problems distract you from everything else that is going on in your life.

Lay the small, medium and large slides on the floor and explain to the class that we're going to lay down some problems and the circle has to decide which category they should fit in, and why.

Some helpful probing questions may include:

- Is it a problem you've seen before?

- Is it preventing you from doing the other things you need to do and like to do every day?

Ask the group if they have their own examples of minor, medium or large problems with a reminder of the community standards that have been set around confidentiality and respect. Students may wish to share their own experiences with seeking help on their own and what the experience was like.

Check-out: What would you say to someone who called you weak for seeking help?

Drug Land

Topic

Alcohol use, risk-taking behaviour

Materials

- Drinking categories on pieces of paper (see appendix)
- Consequences of alcohol use (see appendix)
- Alcohol and the media sheets (see appendix)

Background

- Clear a space on the floor large enough for the group to stand in a circle.
- Arrange chairs outside this area in a circle.
- Approach a student who may be willing to volunteer first and break the ice when it's time to disclose drinking habits.
- Facilitators are encouraged to participate in this activity.

Activity

Refer to the community standards and remind everyone about the importance of confidentiality and remaining non-judgmental.

Check-in: Why do teenagers drink?

Ask the students to arrange the categories on the floor from Non-drinker to Alcohol Dependent.

Define each category of drinkers with the students. Emphasize both regularity and severity of drinking.

Ask for a volunteer to stand on the category that best represents their own alcohol use. Explain that students can position themselves in-between categories.

Ask others who are comfortable with contributing where they would put themselves on the spectrum.

Ask the students to move to where they think they will be when they are legal drinking age. Repeat for when they go to community college or university, when they enter the workforce and if they start a family. As students move, ask them to explain their rationale.

Explain that the average age Nova Scotians have their first alcoholic drink has dropped from 15 to 13, and that it's becoming more important for younger

Outcomes

Students will be expected to:

- 9.13 analyze the role of alcohol in the decision making process related to increased risk of unintended pregnancy, STIs, impaired driving, and injury.
- 9.14 practise speaking about concerns regarding substance use and gambling in self or others.

Note

Research shows one in five Nova Scotia drinkers (15 years or older) consume alcohol in a way that damages their health or well-being (N.S. Dept. of Health Promotion and Protection, 2007). The average age of a Nova Scotian taking their first drink is 13 years old (N.S. Dept. of Health and Wellness, 2011).

Drug Land

Extensions

Try to get the group to order the consequence sheets in silence for the first 2 minutes; practising non-verbal communication.

Discuss what to do in case of alcohol poisoning, passing out, or other dangers of alcohol consumption.

Demonstrate the recovery position

References

Changing the Culture of Alcohol Use in Nova Scotia [An Alcohol Strategy to Prevent and Reduce the Burden of Alcohol-Related Harm in Nova Scotia]. (2007). Retrieved from Nova Scotia Department of Health Promotion and Protection website: <http://novascotia.ca/dhw/addictions/documents/Changing-the-Culture-of-Alcohol-Use-in-Nova-Scotia-Strategy.pdf>

Alcohol Indicators Report. (2011). Retrieved from Nova Scotia Government Department of Health of Wellness website: <http://novascotia.ca/dhw/publications/Alcohol-Indicators-Report-2011.pdf>

students to consider the consequences of substance abuse. Be clear that the point of this activity is not to demonize alcohol, but you want students to be as informed as possible.

Ask a volunteer to read the consequences of alcohol use one by one. Quickly explain each as they are laid on the floor and sort them into 2 piles: things that group members have seen happen or heard about and things that don't seem to happen.

Ask the group to order the consequences in the pile that 'happen' from what they perceive to be the least harmful to the most harmful. Students will develop their own rationale for what constitutes "harm." Discuss how often they see these in their community.

Discussion

- Review the order and ask if this is the impression they get from the media. (i.e. do major companies put warnings on beer labels like "May cause sexual assault"? How are women portrayed in beer ads?)
- Are these media related to the drinking or smoking habits of your peers or of even younger students?
- Discuss binge drinking amongst teens and teenage girls in particular and connect this with the script of masculinity/femininity. Explore the idea of drinking to get smashed or to be the most fun person at a party. Discuss the risk of alcohol positioning associated with binge drinking.
- Discuss how the media influences our perception and culture of alcohol, use the 'media and alcohol' sheets to fuel discussion. How does being away of the influence they have change how you see alcohol?

Ask students if they would have been comfortable using to the same activity to discuss marijuana or prescription drugs. Inform the group prescription drugs are medicine. Doctors give them to patients who are sick or injured. If you're not sick or injured and take a prescription drug it can hurt you. A drug can lead to a dependence or addiction, it can make you sick or increase your chances of an injury, and in some cases it can kill you. They're especially harmful when mixed with other drugs, like alcohol. If you're taking them because you're sad or upset there are healthier ways to deal with those feelings.

Check-out: How did this activity make you feel?

Marijuana

Topic

Social pressures, marijuana use, refusal skills

Materials

- Levels of marijuana use (see appendix)
- Pressures to try marijuana (see appendix)
- Blank paper
- Markers

Background

- This activity should be done once a good level of trust has been developed in the group. Be open to discussion and hearing students' ideas.
- Be careful not to reveal the topic of the activity prior to beginning the session.

Activity

Inform the group that you'll be talking about something they're all familiar with. Tell them it's something they hear about in songs, see in movies, and hear about from people at school. It's something they see in the news, and something they can buy supplies for in the store.

Ask the group to guess what you're talking about (they will likely guess sex or alcohol) before revealing you're talking about marijuana. Let them know the goal of the day is to have an honest discussion about marijuana in their lives (experienced or perceived).

Check-in: What are some words/phrases for marijuana or getting high? (Extend by talking about whether these make it seem appealing or not appealing.)

Place the "Levels of use" sheets on the floor and clarify the meaning of each with the group. Begin Step in the Circle, starting asking students to step in the circle based on the level of use, then moving to the pressures of using marijuana that apply to their lives.

Discuss the ways someone could refuse a joint in certain situations (e.g. at a

Outcomes

Students will be expected to:

- 9.3 recognize the impact that substance use and gambling can have on mental health issues, including depression and anxiety.
- 9.7 synthesize the fundamentals of drug education related to the use of alcohol, tobacco, caffeine, cannabis and other substances, including the short and long term risks and signs of concerns along the continuum of use.
- 9.12 identify and practice negotiation, assertiveness and refusal skills related to sexual activity, tobacco, cannabis and gambling.

Marijuana

Extensions

- Try a “soft-shoe shuffle” during the discussion: ask everyone to stand and as volunteers answer each question, the rest of the class moves closer to person if they agree and farther away if they disagree. Ask for multiple answers for each question to see how the class moves.
- Discuss marijuana use and social capital. Does it give you a way to identify with a certain group?
- Discuss and question assumptions about marijuana: marijuana is non-addictive; healthy and natural; helps your focus.
- Have students create an advertisement to “Sell Marijuana to kids” the way youth are often targeted in advertisements. Use this to discuss potential harms and tactics used by alcohol advertisements.

party with all the same sex, both sexes, older friends, at lunchtime, at a concert). What makes these situations easier/harder to refuse?

Discussion

Ask the group to imagine marijuana was legal. Ask the group to develop the following rules/laws for use. Have one student mediate the discussion.

- What would be the legal age?
- Is driving high allowed? What about ambulance drivers, bus drivers?
- Can your doctor be high?
- Where/how would you get it? Who would decide the cost?
- Could your parents get high?

Be open about the goal for this lesson – you’re not ignoring the realities of experimentation, but you’d like them to think about delaying their first use.

Check-out: Your three year old child can identify the smell of weed. Is this okay? If not, what could change to make sure this isn’t the case?

Relationships

Outcomes

Students will be expected to:

- 9.22 examine the cause and effect of unhealthy relationships and practice communication and assertiveness to confront unhealthy relationships.

Topic

Friendships, intimate relationships, body image

Materials

- Sheet of scenarios (see appendix)

Background

- It is important for the facilitator to be sensitive to the relationships between students in the group, and consider the relationships they see at home.

Activity

Check-in: Would you date yourself, or be friends with yourself? Why or why not? **NOTE:** Sometimes students may find this question confusing...they may think you're asking them to be gay. You're not, although that can be stated as an option. You're asking the question to have them reflect on their personality and whether or not you'd make a good friend or boyfriend.

Part One

Ask two or three volunteers who are friends to come and stand in the circle about one metre apart so they can see each other. The exercise can be repeated with more than one group.

Ask the guys the following questions:

How did you become friends?
What makes your friendship work?
How does the friendship make you feel?

Now explain that you're going to name some scenarios that might impact the relationship and you'll either move closer to each other, farther away from each other, or stay the same distance apart. Your movement expresses what happens to your relationship as friends. Do you get closer or drift apart a bit? After each statement you can pause and ask for feedback on the movements. Modify the wording if there are three people in the circle. You don't have to use all the scenarios.

Notes

Adolescents may be aware of a growing number of different relationships that impact their daily lives and ones that can influence and impact their health and sense of well-being (family, friends, teachers, partners, etc.). Healthy relationships are an important part of our physical, mental and emotional health. In this lesson students will be given opportunities to think critically about what makes a relationship healthy and what might make a relationship unhealthy.

Relationships

Facilitators can try a couple of rounds with different students, or they can ask the circle to facilitate their own round – choosing two or three new students and asking the guys in the circle to throw out some of the same scenarios, and also some of their own (see appendix for scenarios).

How did this exercise make you feel? Why do you think someone might stay friends with a guy when the relationship doesn't feel right or healthy?

Part Two

Since you have been young you have had many kinds of relationships. The relationship with our families is the first kind that we experience and by the time we entered grade primary, friendships began to take a bigger role in our lives and still do. Now at this stage of your life, you may have or be thinking about another kind of relationship. We sometimes call them romantic relationships or intimate relationships – having a boyfriend or girlfriend. These kinds of relationships can be a rich addition to your life, and can help you be healthier. Sometimes though they can be unhealthy. This part of the lesson is designed to help us understand how to maintain a healthy relationship, and how to recognize when a relationship is becoming unhealthy.

Ask the whole circle to participate in this activity about healthy intimate relationships. Canvas the group for feedback after each question (see appendix for questions).

The questions we just asked help us understand the differences between a healthy and an unhealthy relationship. Stand up and step into the circle if you think you would recognize if you were in an unhealthy relationship. Step into the circle if you think you know how to help build and maintain a healthy relationship. Step into the circle if you think it might take some time before you're ready for a healthy relationship. End this part of the session with the following thought:

What you say and what you do will make people feel something. It might be something good or bad. It might help a relationship or hurt a relationship.

Part Three

Finish off the class, if there's time, with some questions for the group or some additional Step into the Circle statements (see appendix).

Check-out: Complete these sentences.

When I admire a relationship it's because...

When I'm turned off by a relationship it's because...

Extensions

- Extend with similar questions about familial relationships. What makes them different and are they always healthy?
- Examine what your options are if you find yourself in an unhealthy relationship and how you know this. Practice communication strategies and emphasize the importance of addressing these feelings.
- Ask students: What's one thing you would like to change about yourself to make you a better friend or better boyfriend?

Assessment

In a following class ask the students to design a code of conduct or set of rules for friendships and relationships. Three rules for each.

Sexuality Kitchen Sink

Outcomes

Students will be expected to:

- 9.16 examine issues around hypersexualization of girls and boys and the sexualization of women and men, and how these phenomena can contribute to violence, affect body image and self-esteem and impact relationships.

Topic

Healthy Sexuality

Materials

- Prepared slides (see appendix)

Background

- Preceding this session an anonymous question box could be used to gather what students might want to know about.
- Arrange chairs in a circle.
- If a student decides to share personal information remind the class about their community standards around confidentiality and respect; and also remind youth that there are people and resources in the community where students can get more support for an issue related to sex and sexuality.

Activity

Check-in: How and where would you like your kids to learn about sex (examples could include movies, school, parents, friends, etc.)?

Arrange 30 frequently asked questions (FAQs) about sex somewhere in the room with five to 10 markers nearby, or a marker for every student.

Tell the students to quickly move through the FAQs and put a mark on 10 questions they want answered. The facilitator will take the top 10 questions, plus 10 more they believe are important based on their experience and bring them back to the circle.

Take the questions the students picked and answer them first. One suggestion is to pose the question and first ask if the circle has an answer. It may be the correct answer, it may require some additional information, or it may require the facilitator to provide the right answer.

Do the same with the questions identified with the facilitator.

Invite the students to ask new questions, and let them know there will be time during other sessions to answer the remaining questions.

Notes

With puberty comes a range of physical, mental and emotional changes, and many of these changes are associated with sex and sexuality. Many teenagers are curious about sex and sexuality, but seldom have a safe space where questions can be answered.

Sexuality Kitchen Sink

Sample FAQs

- Do all vaginas look alike?**
- What does a clitoris do?**
- Do other parts of the body become aroused?**
- What's the average size for a penis?**
- Do all penises look alike?**
- How much masturbation is normal?**
- What's in semen and where does it come from?**
- Can sexual intercourse hurt?**
- Is pulling out of the vagina or anus and ejaculating a safe form of birth control or safer sex?**
- What is pre cum?**
- If you masturbate too much will you run out of sperm?**
- If I'm attracted to someone of the same gender does it mean I'm gay or bi?**
- What's an orgasm?**
- Is a male orgasm different from a female orgasm?**
- Can alcohol and other drugs, and tobacco impact your sexual health?**
- Do females masturbate?**
- Should I shave my pubic hair?**
- What does circumcision mean and does it impact our health?**
- What's a wet dream?**
- What are blue balls?**
- What if I'm having trouble getting an erection and ejaculating?**
- How many erections each day are normal?**
- When does puberty start and stop?**
- How much cum is normal?**
- What is birth control?**
- What does horny mean and what's normal?**
- What's lube all about?**
- What are periods and are they gross?**

Extensions

Ask at the end of the session which unanswered questions seem the most important now. Follow up with these in the next session or get volunteers to research them and bring back the answers next time.

Closing:

The more youth know about their body, the better they are to help keep it healthy. Encourage youth to ask questions about sex.

Check-out: What's one memorable (useful?) fact you took away today?

Man Up!

Outcomes

Students will be expected to:

9.15 examine the negative impact of stereotyping upon help-seeking behaviour

Topic

Masculine stereotypes, expectations of women

Materials

- One copy of *Man Up* by Dwayne Morgan for every student (see Appendix)
- List of Expectations of Women (see Appendix)
- Up to 20 blank pieces of paper

Background

- Students will be asked to read out loud in this activity. Some students might have trouble reading or following along.

Activity

Check-in: Play two truths and a lie. Each student thinks of 3 facts about themselves; one is a lie and the other 2 are true. The group guesses which one is the lie.

Explain to the group you'll be reading a poem about masculinity. Hand out one copy of the poem to each person.

Read *Man Up* once out loud and ask the group to read along and listen for the pronunciation of place names and tougher vocabulary. Let them know they'll be reading next.

Read the poem as a group. One person should read each line going around the circle. Everyone should say "Man up!" in unison each time it is said.

Repeat the poem once more; standing up and with more emphasis now that the group is comfortable with the text.

Ask each student to select a line that stood out for him and explain his reasoning. Encourage the group to relate their answers to "the script" from the Expectations of Men activity.

Explain to the group that men are not alone in feeling societal pressures and that women have their own backpack full of expectations. Ask the group to try to identify the pressures women face and write each one on a piece of paper.

Man Up!

Compare the list you've created to the list of pressures from the Expectations of Women activity in the girls group package. Discuss any differences in the two lists.

Check-out: What happens to girls who feel pressured to live up to the list of expectations for them?

Extensions

- Have the group present their list of expectations to the other group. Allow time for questions about any differences in the generated list and the "official" list.
- Have students write their own poems about the expectations they face.

References

Morgan, Dwayne. (2011). Man up! *Dwayne Morgan's Writer's Corner*. Retrieved from <http://dwaynemorgan.ca/writerscorner/2011/09/12/man-up-by-dwayne-morgan/>.

Online and Offline

Topic

Social Media, relationships

Outcomes

Students will be expected to:

9.16 examine issues around hypersexualization of girls and boys and the sexualization of women and men, and how these phenomena can contribute to violence, affect body image and self-esteem and impact relationships .

Materials

- Pages with examples of social media activity (see appendix)

Background

- Consider mixing the two groups for this activity.
- Prepare a list of social media blunders you can use in your fake interviews. For example, “I saw a picture on Instagram of you throwing up in someone’s flower pot,” “Your Twitter account seems to be mostly concerned with rating porn videos,” “Your Facebook statuses are always complaining about school. How will I know you won’t complain to your friends about work?”
- Arrange chairs in a circle

Activity

Check-in: What would be your ideal summer job and what would be your ideal career?

Tell the group you’ll be role-playing job interviews so they can have a taste of what to expect when they begin to look for summer jobs.

Choose a student to participate in a mock job interview. Start with general questions such as asking for their greatest strengths or weaknesses.

When the student feels comfortable, ask a question about their social media activity: “What would I learn about you from looking at your social media accounts?”

Start asking more specific questions: “You said _____ about your teacher on Twitter. What can I expect from you as an employee?” “You’ve changed your Facebook profile picture 10 times in two weeks; what’s your time management strategy?” etc.

Repeat if you have other volunteers. Inform the group that potential employers

Online and Offline

Extensions

- Have students identify ads they see on social media that seem to be targeted to their interests. Discuss the implications of having information online.

will sometimes search for people on various social media sites.

Reveal to students you're actually focusing on how their online lives interact with their real-world lives.

Start a round of Step in the Circle. Here are some suggested statements:

- I pay attention to the number of Twitter followers I have.
- I've friended someone I don't know.
- I have more than two social media accounts.
- I've said something online/texted that I wouldn't say face-to-face.
- I think about who's reading my Facebook statuses.

Spread the social media activity pages (see appendix) on the floor and ask the group to arrange them into two piles: "OK" and "Not OK."

Ask the group to explain their rationale for each choice and to describe whether they'd changed their minds on any of the examples. For example, the students might only put sheets in the "Not OK" pile if they violate laws such as child porn or cyber-bullying. Discuss whether the law is only factor in deciding their actions in real life.

Bring up the idea of online safety. What are some consequences of making your phone number public? How much do you reveal about yourself if you're talking to someone online for the first time?

Go back to the job interview. Identify that people in interviews try to project the best image, regardless of whether it's the "real you." Discuss whether a social media profile is a more accurate representation of someone's personality. Suggest that an online persona is also a form of performance. Where is the "real you?" What factors influence these performances?

Check-out: What's something you regret putting online?

The Need to Succeed

Outcomes

Students will be expected to:

9.18 examine the social, legal and financial impacts of alcohol, other substances and gambling along a continuum of use

9.16 examine issues around hypersexualisation of girls and boys and the sexualisation of women and men, how these phenomena can contribute to violence, affect body image and self-esteem and impact relationships

Topic

Healthy competition, self-esteem, gambling, societal expectations

Materials

- Small prizes (enough for the whole group)

Background

- Arrange chairs in a circle with enough space in the middle for the group to move around freely.
- Based on the group size, designate the maximum level they are reach in Rock-paper-scissors (i.e. level 20 for a group of 15).

Activity

Check-in: What is one thing you hate to lose? Say this quietly, at a normal volume and very loud.

Round 1

Ask students to spread out in the open space. Explain that they will play rock-paper-scissors, moving up one level every time they win. They must track and share their level with the group.

Rules:

- You can only challenge someone on the same level as you.
- You must play when challenged.
- If you win, you go up one level. If you lose, you go down one.
- Once you reach the designated top level, inform the instructor.

Allow a few minutes for the game. When a student reaches the top level they are awarded a prize and sit in a chair.

Keep track of how many students were in the top few and bottom few levels. **Watch for students who bend the rules, and use these observations in later discussions.**

The Need to Succeed

Round 2

This time when you lose a challenge you stay the same level. All other rules will remain the same.

Discussion

- How did each round make you feel?
- What is it about winning that feels good? Do you need “losers” for winning to feel good?
- What makes a good winner or loser?
- Would this game have felt differently if girls were playing? Do you feel a stronger need to win when you are playing a game with boys or boys and girls?
- Imagine the prize was a million dollars. If you were given the option to play again after losing, would you want to? What if each match-up cost you \$10?
- Think of all of the things you compete in (video games, sports, academics, etc.). How does your opinion of winning or losing differ between these?

Emphasize and discuss the value and the inevitability of failure and how you can use it as a means to grow and move forward.

Check-out: Describe a time you lost but didn’t fail.

Extensions

- Play a third round with some students going down one level with a loss, and some staying the same. This could be used to discuss the idea of fairness and social stratification.
- Incorporate a game that is less up to chance, and see how competitiveness and honesty changes.
- Instead of achieved levels being shared, keep the level you have reached in your head and play against others of any level. Discuss how success being public or private impacts how you feel.

Gender and Sexuality

Outcomes

Students will be expected to:

- 9.15 examine the negative impact of stereotyping upon help-seeking behaviour

Topic

Homophobia, communication, restorative skills development

Materials

- “Your best friend comes out” questions (see appendix)
- Copy of William’s Doll by Charlotte Zolotow (see appendix)
- “Your best friend comes out” extension questions (see appendix)

Background

- This activity would be best if conducted later in the sequence, after some trust has been developed throughout the group.
- Use deliberate language throughout the sessions (choosing words like partner, male-identified and female-identified). During this session, the facilitator should remind students about the use of respectful and appropriate language and address any inappropriate terms as they come up.
- Arrange chairs in a circle.

Activity

Read the story “William’s Doll” to the group.

Check-in: if you were William’s father, would you allow him to have a doll?

Explain that the story touches on gender stereotypes, but also homophobia—discriminating against members of the gay and lesbian communities based on their sexuality. Biphobia and transphobia are different phenomena and can be explored in a follow-up activity. It may be useful to review vocabulary here.

Lay out the “Your best friend comes out” scenarios on the floor and allow students to read through them. Explain to them that their best friend has just told them he is gay. Ask for a volunteer from the group to answer each question, or work through each question as a group. Encourage honest feelings and discuss the ideas that emerge.

Present the group with a scenario to examine and resolve. This same best friend is walking down the hall when another friend of yours pushes him into the

Gender and Sexuality

locker. You are the only person who sees this, and you know you are all planning to go out that night. As a group they must come to a consensus regarding what the next action is. You may want to help guide this, or leave the room for 15 minutes to allow them to work it out.

Alternatively, two facilitators could act this scenario out and the group could facilitate a restorative circle to re-establish trust and move forward from the incident. For more information on the restorative approach visit the Nova Scotia Department of Justice website.

Discussion

If you walked into a toy store and all of the “boys” and “girls” toys were mixed up, would that be wrong? Why? This could lead into a discussion about gendered space, and who/what determines what is suitable for a boy or girl.

When you think of someone who is lesbian, gay, bisexual or trans, what do you think? What words come to mind? Why?

It may be useful for you to create a space that allows for some confusion around vocabulary as well as genetic vs. learned behaviour. Clarify terminology and address these questions to allow for increased understanding.

Check-out: What can you do to make sure all students feel welcome in your school?

Extensions

- Invite a facilitator to train the group in restorative circles.
- Expand on the “Your best friend comes out” questions with specific examples (see appendix), challenging what the students are saying and provoking true conversation about homophobia. Ask for one student to represent the friend, and have two volunteers decide if they think certain activities are off-limits now that they know this friend is gay.
- The Youth Project is a powerful resource for discussions on these topics. They provide guest speakers and teacher resources for schools all around the province.

References

Zolotow, C. (1972). William’s Doll. New York : Harper & John.

The Youth Project:
www.youthproject.ns.ca/
or youthproject@youthproject.ns.ca

Privilege

Outcomes

Students will be expected to:

- 9.22 examine how design and infrastructure of the school community and surrounding community enhances or creates barriers for physical activity among youth
- 9.23 investigate principles of and beliefs around financial health and demonstrate an awareness of the capacity for financial health to positively or negatively affect ones' state of health

Privilege, social determinants of health

Materials

- Printed ducks and towns (appendix)
- 'The Line' questions (appendix)
- Social determinants of health on sheets (appendix)

Background

- Arrange chairs in a circle
- Depending on the group, it may be necessary to express the importance of maintaining a safe space during this discussion as students will share personal information.

Activity

Check in: What is something about you that you think makes you different from everyone else in the room? Try to go deeper than name. If students do share a difference that turns out to be the same as someone else in the group

Introduce the 10 ducks. Explain that all of these ducks were born basically identical in the same duck hospital, the only difference being that they were born in two different ponds . Allow the students to name these two ponds.

Explain that Pond 1 ducks live to be 12 years old—really old for a duck—and Pond 2 ducks live to be 7. Ask students what might be going on in each pond.

Ask the group to identify some things affecting the life span and health of the ducks in these two ponds. As they identify them drop the social determinant of health that this relates to on the floor until each has been mentioned. Stop periodically to question students (e.g. "But how does education affect your life span?").

Note

This session is best done in a multi-gender group to help showcase the difference in privilege between gender groups.

Privilege

After students have identified all of the social determinants that they can with the ducks flip the paper over to reveal the town. Ask students to identify the remaining social determinants by thinking in terms of people and their communities.

Explain that these factors are the social determinants of health, and that this means your health is influenced by your place in society. Explain that these factors don't predict the future but they create barriers for some people that don't exist for others; making it harder for them. Important is the message that **any** duck can rise out of any pond to succeed.

Ask for volunteers to talk about how they fare personally as a particular social determinant is concerned (i.e. "How is your access to education?").

Ask students to stand up and push back all of the chairs to the wall. Students should line up across the middle of the room leaving a few feet in front and behind themselves (not facing each other).

Use the list of questions to instruct students to either step forward or back. This should be done in silence.

When all of the questions have been asked prompt students to look around and see the variation in the room and then return to the circle.

Solicit volunteers who ended up at different places in the room and ask them how the activity felt and why they think they ended up where they did. Introduce the word 'privilege' for what was just measured in that activity. It is important to reinforce that privilege is not destiny but certainly can make things harder for some people than other. It is also important to point out that everyone is privileged in some ways and not in others but that people need to be conscious of how their privilege manifests itself.

Ask students to go around the circle and name one way that they are privileged and one way they are not; based on those questions or not.

Discussion

- Should you feel guilty for your privilege? Do you?
- What can you do if you are very privileged to make things better for others?

Remind students of the positive effects of an activity like this; especially of finding out our similarities with others.

Check out: How did this session feel to you?

Extensions

Here are ways to modify the activity:

- Begin the 'Design your own neighbourhood' project referenced in the assessment materials
- Play the board game "The Last Straw" as a group.
- Show a video of "The Line" taking place with another group ("What is Privilege?" by BuzzFeed Yellow on Youtube, for example).

Note

The line activity could be done with eyes closed or open. The group may have a preference but facilitators should be aware to watch out for situations that might make students feel unsafe or singled out.

Masculinity Creep

Outcomes

Students will be expected to:

9.11 examine the cause and effect of unhealthy relationships and practice communication and assertiveness skills to confront unhealthy relationships.

Topic

Pack mentality, safety

Materials

- Flipchart paper
- Markers
- Masculinity Creep sheets (see Appendix)

Background

- Arrange chairs in a circle.

Activity

Check-in: Describe a time you felt pressure to do something you didn't want to do.

Play Amoeba Tag: At the beginning of the game, one person is "it." Once he tags someone else, they link arms and try to tag another person. Each person who is tagged links arms and the "amoeba" grows until either everyone is tagged or the large group can't get to the one or two remaining players.

Come back to the circle and debrief the game. Ask the group to determine what the amoeba gained and lost as it absorbed more people. You could record the answers on flipchart paper. If students don't bring it up, suggest that the individual parts of the amoeba lose their ability to choose their own direction as it absorbs more people—some people may surrender their decision-making abilities.

Ask the group to consider that they may see the same effect in their own lives. Set up a step into the circle; everyone stands in a circle and the facilitator or a student volunteer reads directions that begin with "Step into the circle if..." (see Appendix). Students can take bigger steps in to show greater agreement with a statement or could take a step backward if they strongly disagree.

Masculinity Creep

Discussion

- What makes it easier to act a certain way in a group? Direct discussion back to the amoeba.
- If members of a group lose some of their individuality, where do the ideas for these actions come from? Is there a group leader, or does belonging to a group allow you to take more risks?
- When is it easier to defy expectations: in a group or individually?
- What happens to a man who stands up against these acts?
- Is masculinity in competition with femininity?
- How can these actions affect the health of men and women?

Use the “Stand up” statements (see Appendix) and ask the students to stand if they agree with the statement.

Check-out: Describe a time you pressured someone to do something they didn’t want to do.

Extensions

Ask the group to order the Masculinity Creep pages from most common to least common, then from what they see as most harmful to least harmful. Discuss the similarities and differences between the two lists.

Ask students to research “micro-aggression” and reflect on times they have been a part of either end of small aggressive acts.

Drawing the Line

Outcomes

Students will be expected to:

- 9.10 apply communication and interpersonal skills to discuss reproductive and sexual health issues.

Topic

Sexual acts, consent

Materials

- Pieces of paper with one sexual act on them each (see Appendix)
- Consent scenarios (see Appendix)
- Sexual Acts survey (see Appendix)

Background

- Clear space and create a circle of chairs.
- Check in question: If you plan on being a parent, when will your child's curfew be and how strict will you be with your rules?
- Approach a volunteer to read out the sexual acts.

Activity

Ask students to imagine themselves as parents to 15-year-old sons. A volunteer should read out the acts and as a group they should divide them into a pile that are OK and a pile that are not. *Allow the group to discuss each one themselves; although you may need to designate a judge to step in to facilitate a vote for some.*

When they have finished, ask them to now imagine that they have 15-year-old daughters and to go through the piles again. *Typically students are stricter here.* Ask students how it might be different if it were their daughter with a girlfriend. Their son with a boyfriend?

Discussion

Why are there differences for sons and daughters?

What if your son/daughter were not interested in sex at all? *(Note: A third of Canadian teens reported never having had sex at age 19 in 2010)*

Point out that they may be saying they are OK with their son doing something with someone else's daughter that they wouldn't be OK with their

Drawing the Line

own daughter doing. What does it mean to protect your daughters by talking to your son?

As males, do they also give consent? Relate this idea to the pressures of masculinity discussed in the backpack activity.

Clarify what's necessary for consent, including age of consent and intoxication and consent (*if one or both parties are intoxicated there is no consent and it could lead to charges*).

Give example scenarios or ask for the group for scenarios to discuss consent (see appendix).

Extensions

Here are ways to modify the activity:

- Designate one side of the class as having sons and one as having daughters. Have them debate where the line should be drawn for 15 year old boys.
- Discuss the difference between the “no means no” campaign and the alternative, “yes means yes.”
- Show the “Consent and Tea” video: <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=fGoWLWS4-kU>

Note

Consent cannot be forced and cannot be obtained after use of force, threats, fear of bodily harm, or by lying.

If you are 12 or 13 years old you can legally have consensual sex with someone who is less than 2 years older than you.

If you are 14 or 15 years old you can legally have consensual sex with someone less than 5 years older than you.

16 is the legal age of consent.

18 is the legal age for pornography and prostitution.

You can't legally consent to have sex with someone who is in a position of authority or trust over you; for example a minister, coach, employer, teacher, or police officer (Dept. of Justice, 2013).

References

Age of Consent to Sexual Activity. (2013). Retrieved from Government of Canada, Department of Justice website: www.justice.gc.ca/eng/rp-pr/other-autre/clp/faq.html

Bods for Bros

Outcomes

Students will be expected to:

- 9.15 examine the negative impact of stereotyping upon help-seeking behaviour.
- 9.16 examine issues around hypersexualization of girls and boys and the sexualization of women and men, and how these phenomena can contribute to violence, affect body image and self-esteem and impact relationships.

Notes

Body images issues affect the health of many teens. Youth of all genders may be bad about the way their body or parts of their body look; and they may feel pressure to change the way their body looks based on how bodies are portrayed in advertising and marketing, and elsewhere in pop culture, including social media, television, movies, etc. Some students are feeling stress and anxiety about their bodies that can lead to substance misuse, eating disorders, unhealthy forms and degrees of exercise, etc. The purpose of the activity is to create space for a conversation about the pressures we feel about our bodies and the connections to health.

Topic

Body image

Materials

- Prepared slides (see appendix)
- Sticky notes
- Pens or markers

Background

- Arrange chairs in a circle.

Activity

Check-in: What do you think you'll look like when you're 50 years old?

On the floor inside the circle is a man assembled with 11 prepared and numbered slides (Facial Hair, White Teeth, Tanned Skin (if white), Six Pack, Big Penis, No Body Hair, No Disabilities, No Fat, Tall and Muscular, Clear Skin and Other). The facilitator explains that these slides represent the known expectations that some guys feel is the ideal masculine body. Ask the group if there are suggestions for the "other" category (have some extra blank sheets of paper just in case there are agreed upon suggestions).

Ask each student to consider the slides on the floor and answer the following question to themselves: I wish I had/was _____. Ask the students to answer as honestly as possible.

To ensure confidentiality each student will take a sticky note and pen/marker and on their own list all the numbers that apply to them based on the question you asked. The facilitator will collect the sticky notes and quickly populate the slides with the answers by placing an "x" on each one that is checked by the students. For example, if three students marked "Facial Hair" then the facilitator should mark an "x" three times on the Facial Hair slide.

Hopefully there will be some trends, with some slides marked more than others. The facilitator can then start a discussion with the following questions:

Are you surprised by what you see?

When you look at the whole guy (all the pressures and expectations) does every guy look like the guy on the floor?

What if all of us looked like this guy?

Do these physical traits mean a guy is healthy? Does this body mean you're happy?

Look at what was marked the most...how would these changes make you healthier or better?

Bods for Bros

NOTE: Admittedly, some of these changes might improve aspects of your life, for example going from 5'4" to 6'2" might improve your chances of playing high school basketball. As well, we don't want the exercise to demonize exercise and getting in better physical condition, including weight training.

The facilitator will turn all the slides over to reveal a woman with some of the same and some different pressures that girls feel about what their body should look like. Ask everyone to take a marker and put an "x" on the physical traits and pressures that they think girls they know are feeling. You may ask them to mark as many as they like, or only their top three to five pressures.

Now shift the conversation to a long-term relationship and ask the class to suggest three to five non-physical attributes a person should have for a successful long-term loving relationship. We're talking about personality characteristics here – not things like "they have to know how to cook and clean." For example, kind and caring, loyal, funny, generous, supportive, etc.

Write the characteristics they've suggested on separate slides on the floor and place them with the top three to five physical pressures that were identified. Ask one of the students to rank their importance for a great long term relationship - including the most marked physical characteristics slides they had picked. Ask one or two other students to offer up their own opinions for ranking. See if there is some consensus among the group, and allow some time and space for debate.

Ask the group what happens as a couple gets older and physical traits inevitably change (breasts sag, muscles atrophy, hair is lost, height is lost, fat accumulates, etc.). Does the relationship end? If no, why? Perhaps deep inside we know that despite being even today, we ultimately place more weight on personality.

Ask if anyone in the class knows of an elderly couple that is still together after many years and still in love. Ask them if there are still abs, and great breasts. Probably not! Ask then why it is that they're still together if they're not deemed "hot" anymore.

If there is time you may continue the conversation by asking the following questions:

Where do these body image pressures come from? Who's creating the ideal body image for girls and guys?

How does an obsession with body image impact our health, and the health of others?

Which of the attributes on the floor will make you a great and successful father?

How would you feel about your daughter dieting?

How would you feel about your son taking steroids?

What would you say if your kid asked you for money for plastic surgery?

If body image becomes a struggle for you, do you want it to be a struggle for your kid too?

How would you know if a body image issue was beginning to impact your health, and where would you go for help?

Check-out: What are your thoughts on the body images pressures for guys and girls now that you've gone through this lesson? How would you know if a body image issue was beginning to impact your health, and where would you go for help?

Extensions

- Bring in magazines (bodybuilding, fitness, etc.) and examine the messages they are sending about healthy bodies.

Assessment

In a following class, have students work in groups of two or three to brainstorm things they see in movies, television, advertising, videos and anywhere online that might send an unrealistic or negative message about body image, but also anything that might send a more positive message. Was it easier to find negative or positive images around body image? Groups can report back to the whole class.

Porn

Outcomes

Students will be expected to:

9.15 examine the negative impact of stereotyping upon help-seeking behaviour.

9.16 examine issues around hypersexualization of girls and boys and the sexualization of women and men, and how these phenomena can contribute to violence, affect body image and self-esteem and impact relationships .

Topic

Body image, pornography

Materials

- Prepared slides (see appendix)

Background

- If a student decides to share information about their use of porn during the lesson reinforce with the group the community standards around confidentiality and respect.

Activity

Check-in: Can you recall when you first became aware of porn?

Arrange five categories of “porn consumption” on the floor in a circle in the same way as Alcohol Land (No Porn, A Little Bit of Porn, Regular Porn, Lots of Porn, and Porn Dependent). Students are not expected to disclose what they have seen or how much they have seen, rather the slides will serve as an entry point into a discussion about porn and its connection to health.

The facilitator will ask for volunteers to stand on the porn consumption area that they think would be appropriate for a variety of people. You can ask the same volunteer all the questions, or mix it up with as many volunteers as you like. Keep it light. Make sure you probe for rationale around their answers.

Where do think a 10-year-old boy should be standing on this scale and explain your reasoning.

Where would you want your 14 or 15 year old son be standing on this scale and explain your reasoning.

Where do you think most 14 and 15 year old guys are standing on this scale?

Where do you think a guy your age should be standing on this scale if he’s in a relationship?

Continuing on from the last question, if you’re the partner in the relationship, where would you want your boyfriend to be standing on this scale?

If you have a son or daughter, and they’re dating the guy we just mentioned,

Porn

where do you want the boyfriend standing on this scale?

Where do you think an astronaut, on a three-year solo mission to Mars, should be standing on this scale? Explain your reasoning.

Where do you think someone who is very nervous about dating – someone who feels they would be rejected if they asked anyone out – would be on this scale? Explain your reasoning?

Where should a guy your age stand if he has never learned anything about sex and is curious about sex?

Where do you think an adult male should be standing on this scale? What about a father?

These questions allow you to break the ice a bit and make a few points:

There's no one way to feel about porn.

Some people watch it, some people don't. It's all normal.

As we've seen from the above example, how we feel about porn depends on many factors, including age, relationships, how much porn is being watched, the type of porn being watched, etc.

The class will hopefully be warmed up enough that you can raise a few ideas for conversation that may not have surfaced yet.

Direct the discussion towards a reality check about pornography with the following questions and facts. To help get the conversation started lay down the following slides in the middle of the circle: *Body Image, Consent, Alcohol and other Drugs, Violence, Healthy Sexuality, Safer Sex and Porn Creep*. The facilitator should introduce this section by asking students to think about connections between porn and a number of health issues. You can use the following question as a way to start the conversation: *What do you think kids and teenagers learn about these areas if they watch porn?*

Here are some examples and potential questions for the facilitator.

Examples

Body Image – porn may create expectations around breast size and penis size, etc.

Consent – porn is unlikely to include appropriate conversations around consent.

Notes

Facilitators may wish to share a definition of porn with their students: *Pornography can be printed or visual – like a story in a book, a picture or video. Porn describes or shows sexual organs or sexual activity that is designed to stimulate erotic feelings (making someone horny), which can be different from nudity in art – like a painting or sculpture, or nudity in an educational setting.*

Porn

Alcohol and Other Drugs – porn is often made with the performers under the influence of alcohol and other drugs to hide pain or enhance performance.

Violence – some porn may present violence a normal part of sexual activity.

Healthy Sexuality – some porn may create expectations for young people about the kinds of sexual acts they should be doing, and with whom.

Safer Sex – some porn may ignore safer sex practices.

Porn Creep – porn-like images are showing up in advertising and marketing as ways to sell products and services.

Questions

Is there a particular porn body? What does it look like? How does that connect with our health and the health of other genders? Does everyone have a “porn body?”

What messages do you think porn might send about what your sex life should be like?

What messages could porn send about safer sex?

Can porn be good for you? Some porn may present sexual activity in a way that celebrates healthy sexuality – including romance, safer sex, informed consent, healthy body images and the absence of alcohol and other drugs. For someone who has never learned about sex, it might help someone understand some aspects of sex.

Think back to our conversations about consent and now consider how much informed consent there is in pornography. What are your thoughts about porn and consent?

Facilitator Note: The Slide “Porn Creep” is a chance to ask the students if they ever see any advertising and marketing that uses sexualized images, including nudity, to sell products (e.g. alcohol and clothes). Aspects of porn “creep” into other parts of our world.

Facts:

Sometimes people are forced engage in porn against their will.

Sometimes there are drugs involved with porn. Sometimes to mask pain and cope with the experience, and sometimes to enhance performance (e.g. erectile dysfunction drugs).

Assessment

Ask students to answer the question/s on a post it note and provide it to the facilitator as an exit slip.

What part of our discussion today has you thinking about or considering something new in relation to pornography?

Is pornography a topic worth discussing?

How does pornography affect the health of our community?

Have you had discussion about pornography in school prior to this lesson?

Porn

Sometimes it can take days to film a porn scene that is only minutes on screen.

Sometimes porn actors are paid more money to have unsafe sex (e.g. no condoms, etc.).

There's no normal amount of porn use. Some guys watch none, some guys watch a lot. If you find yourself ignoring aspects of your life because of porn that may be a clue that you're watching too much.

Watching porn can give you a skewed image of what a body should look (large breasts and large penis).

Closing:

Take an eighth slide called "Making Porn," and place it in the middle of the circle. Explain that some teens take pornographic images and videos of themselves and others and share them. This is an opportunity to remind students that being involved in porn is legal, but only if you're 18 and older. If you are taking photos or videos under the age of 18 it is illegal and you can be charged with child pornography. There may also be charges involved if you send images and videos, including sexual harassment.

Check-out: How has this class made you feel about pornography?

STIs

Outcomes

Students will be expected to:

- 9.6 identify ways of maintaining sexual health.
- 9.10 apply communication and interpersonal skills to discuss reproductive and sexual health issues.

Topic

Sexual health, STIs, help-seeking

Materials

- Sheet for each STI to be discussed (see appendix)
- Sheets for each symptom to be discussed (see appendix)
- Step into the circle questions (see appendix)

Background

- Set up chairs in a large circle with room in the middle for the group to stand up and walk around.

Activity

Check in: What is the sickest you've ever been?

Begin with everyone standing inside the circle. Students role-play being at a party. They need to fist bump with 3 people; remembering who they were and the order ("you'll never forget your first!"). They may want to write these down on a small piece of paper.

Explain that this is a group of students who party together. Select one student and ask them to stand. Explain that they've had an STI since before the party began. Ask any students who "bumped" with Patient Zero (1st, 2nd or 3rd) to stand, and inform them that they now have an STI. Testing and informing previous partners must happen. Then ask any student who "bumped" with any of these students 2nd or 3rd to stand; they too have an STI. So it goes until everyone who might have the STI is identified.

Ask students the following questions: what did you notice about the spread of the STI? What would you want to do or know to prevent an STI? Does this spread only happen with intercourse?

STIs

Lay the names of the STIs on the floor on one side of the circle and the symptoms on the other side. Ask for a volunteer to stand behind a symptom and let students guess which STI they might have. Use the information sheet in the appendix to determine if they might be right or not. Repeat this a couple of times with new symptoms.

Put the final volunteer behind the “No Symptoms” sheet and ask what they might have. The idea is to let students know that most STIs have no symptoms for a while, and some might never develop symptoms. What does this mean about when you should get tested?

Ask a volunteer to describe an STI test. Share that testing can happen regularly and STIs can be detected with a blood or urine test, no physical exam needed. Stress that students don’t need to be experts on symptoms, but you want them to know about prevention, how to access tests and treatment.

Discussion

- If you thought you had contracted an STI, who might you tell first? Where would you feel comfortable going for treatment?
- Try to dispel myths about testing. A painful swab is not needed, just a blood or urine test that can be done regularly if requested.
- Whose responsibility is it to bring protection or to bring it up?
- How do the expectations of men/women from the backpack activity relate to risks of contracting STIs?
- If some are easily treatable why do we need to prevent them? List the consequences (resistance to treatment, mutation in the virus, risk of pregnancy or sterility, personal morals, etc.)

Conduct a brief Step in the Circle. Students all stand. They step into the circle when the statement applies to them and the distance that they step in can reflect their level of agreement. They can even step back if they strongly disagree. Begin with lighter questions and then use those identified for this session.

Check out: What else to you need to know about sexual health?

Extensions

- Ask students to role-play disclosing their STI status to an ex.
- Discuss whether everyone should receive the HPV vaccine.
- Discuss whether condoms and other preventative measures should be free.
- Discuss some of the choices they see other youth make which would increase risk of STIs (no condom use, multiple partners, etc.)

The Sex Game

Outcomes

Students will be expected to:

- 9.6 identify ways of maintaining sexual health.
- 9.10 apply communication and interpersonal skills to discuss reproductive and sexual health issues.

Topic

Sexual health, birth control, pregnancy

Background

- This activity is purposefully fun to break down some of the taboos and seriousness around sexual health. The facilitator should encourage students to ask any questions they may have on the topic.
- It may be useful to allow students to know the topic prior to the lesson, or set up an anonymous question box in the classroom.
- Arrange chairs in a circle.

Materials

- Condoms (one per student)
- Props for condom-use practice—bananas or similar
- Scrap paper or small white boards
- Sexual health scenarios (see appendix)
- Fact or fiction scenarios (see appendix)
- Condom play activities (see appendix)

Activity

Check-in Question: Have you ever watched a movie/TV show that was rated R or for adults only? What is your first memory of this?

Split the students into small teams, so that you have at least three groups in the class. Explain that we are going to talk about sex and sexual health through small activities. If the facilitator chooses, you can keep score, name the teams, and award a winner at the end.

The Sex Game

Activity

Round 1

Give each group a whiteboard or pile of scrap paper.

Give each group one of the scenarios and a set amount of time to come up with as many options or ‘things to be thinking about’ as possible. Explain that one point will be awarded for each acceptable answer, so they should get as many as possible.

When time is up ask each group to read out the scenario and list their answers. Solicit any additional answers from other groups afterward and ask if there are any questions that the groups would like answered.

Round 2

Complete the condom play activities.

Round 3

Read aloud the “Fact or Fiction” statements and instruct each team to decide if the statement is true (fact) or false (fiction).

Each team should write FACT or FICTION on either side of a piece of paper and all teams wait to reveal their choice at the same time. Discuss the statement and address any questions students may have. A point should be awarded for each correct answer.

Possible Check-out Questions: At what age do you think adolescents are ready to make an informed decision about having sex? At what age would your son be allowed to have sex? Your daughter?

Extensions

Here are ways to modify the activity:

- Award a point for every instance in this session that someone can point out a heteronormative or homophobic comment/assumption.
- Invite the Youth Health Center coordinator or a Youth Health Nurse to speak with the class about the services they provide at the junior high or high school.

Mood

Outcomes

Students will be expected to:

- 9.1 analyze their health needs in times of change and apply strategies that enhance their capacity to manage change in their lives.
- 9.2 recognize the warning signs of depressive disorders and the importance of seeking help for those disorders.

Topic

Detection, coping strategies, help-seeking, empathy

Materials

- Signs and symptoms sheets (see Appendix)
- Deep breathing and other coping strategies descriptions (see Appendix)

Background

- Discussions about mental health should be incorporated into the check-ins throughout the semester to normalize speaking about feelings and thoughts.
- Discussions about suicide should take place only in the context of depression. Students should not go away feeling responsible for friends' suicidal feelings, but should be encouraged to seek adult help if such a situation occurs.
- Arrange chairs in a circle.

Activity

Check-in: What's one thing that always seems to worry you?

Describe "mood" as the way a person feels at a particular time (generally whether someone is feeling good or bad). Mood is sometimes caused by an event, but other times it may not be related to anything specific.

Discuss the effect the length of time a person is worried affects the severity of the issue:

- You're worried about a test or a game for one day
- You're worried for a week
- You're worried for a month

Students should be beginning to differentiate between normal feelings and mental health issues. Explain that everyone experiences stresses, worries, and ups and downs in mood. Share that stress or worry becomes more of an issue when it interferes with normal functioning, as with depression (consistently low mood, sadness) and anxiety (frequent fear or worry).

Ask for a volunteer to move to the middle of the circle and show what anxiety

Mood

looks like and what depression looks like. Ask for another volunteer to demonstrate. As a facilitator, move to the middle and act normal. Ask the group if someone can act normal and still have these feelings.

Share that depression and anxiety are not just experienced in the brain, but have a number of physical signs (something you can see from the outside) and symptoms (something you feel on the inside).

Present the students with the signs and symptoms sheets in no particular order. Ask them to quickly sort the sheets into “signs” and “symptoms.”

Discussion

- How much of what a person is experiencing when anxious or depressed can be seen from the outside?
- What can we do to know how the person really feels (emphasize the importance of deeper communication)?
- How can we support a friend who may be having some of these feelings (emphasize offering support, listening without judgement, validating feelings, and seeking additional help)

Explain that we all have ways of dealing with depressed and anxious feelings: some in the moment and some more long-term. Ask students to share something they do when they're feeling down or anxious. Discuss possible reasons for their behaviours and whether they're helpful. Explain that you can think of these behaviours as messages from the body, like a sore muscle after you exercise.

Share with the group that there are also formal techniques that people can use to reduce anxious feelings or low mood. Introduce the deep breathing exercise.

Check-out: How did the deep breathing exercise feel and how do you feel now?

Extensions

- Formal techniques for managing anxious or depressive feelings should extend, not replace, students' own coping strategies, and are best integrated when acquired over time. Introduce extensions as warm-up or warm-down activities in other lessons as time permits (see Appendix).
- Ask students to keep a journal to record when they feel worried. They can keep track of what upset them and how they dealt with it. If students are comfortable, they can later share their successes or challenges.

Mindfulness

Outcomes

Students will be expected to:

- 9.1 analyze their health needs in times of change and apply strategies that enhance their capacity to manage change in their lives

Topic

Mindfulness, mental health, automatic reactions, coping

Materials

- Word search (see appendix)
- Raisin exercise (see appendix)
- Raisins
- Seven attitudes of mindfulness (see appendix)
- Sitting meditation script (see appendix)

Background

- The purpose of mindfulness is to experience the present moment without judging it as good or bad, and to become aware of automatic thoughts and feelings.
- Some students may find that paying attention to their thoughts and feelings can be upsetting or causes some anxiety. Students should feel free to opt out of any exercises that they find uncomfortable.

Activity

Check in: What is something that frustrates you a lot, and how do you usually react?

Ask a volunteer to sit in the middle of a circle and work on a word search puzzle. Select another volunteer to sit with and say discouraging things to the student working to solve the puzzle.

Share that the puzzle activity represents the kind of inner dialogue we carry out inside ourselves when feeling anxious or discouraged. Explain to the group that when we're frustrated, upset, or stressed, it's like there's a mental tornado in our minds—thoughts and feelings are whirling around in our heads, but it's hard to focus on any one of them.

Explain that, when people are stressed or frustrated, they may react automatically to situations without thinking about what they are saying or doing. By intentionally paying attention to thoughts and feelings, students can learn to react in more helpful ways.

Mindfulness

Share the definition of mindfulness: Mindfulness means paying attention in a particular way: On purpose, in the present moment, and nonjudgmentally. Explain that mindfulness is a form of meditation that has been used to help people cope with stress, anxiety, depression, and illness.

Let the group know that mindfulness is not something you can do wrong, and is not about getting rid of difficult feelings or thoughts; it is about being present with them.

Introduce the raisin exercise. Students are asked to take a few raisins each and eat them as part of a whole group. Share that people tend to eat quickly and without savouring the experience of eating (taste, texture, aromas, etc.). Each student is then given one raisin and instructed not to eat it until prompted. Introduce the mindful eating script. Explain that the goal is to pay closer attention to sensations and experiences as they are happening. Encourage students to participate without judging their experiences as good or bad.

Note: Popcorn, crackers, carrots, gummy bears, or chocolate can be used as substitutes for raisins.

Discussion

- What did you notice from the experience of eating this way?
- Ask the group what it would be like to do other activities mindfully (examples: Walking to school, brushing teeth, doing chores, etc.)

Share that paying attention in this way can have a calming effect for some people. Explain that mindfulness offers the greatest benefit when it is done regularly as a practice. Mindfulness can be thought of as a preventative strategy for stabilizing mood, rather than a quick fix during periods of crisis or acute stress.

Explain the seven attitudes of mindfulness as an introduction to the guided sitting meditation. Relate these attitudes back to the raisin exercise.

Encourage students to share any thoughts about the exercise, how it felt, or how they are feeling after doing it. Ask the group if they noticed any challenges in doing meditation.

Check-out: What is one thing, big or small, that you're feeling grateful for today?

Mindfulness

Note

Mindfulness is derived from eastern meditative practices and has a history that extends beyond applications in mental health. Affixing goals to the practice of mindfulness (examples: to become more relaxed, work through difficult feelings, experience greater empathy, etc.), in some ways, goes against its philosophical core of being non-directive and non-striving. Students and facilitators should be aware that, while there are documented benefits to mindfulness, they should not be promoted as the goals of practice itself.

Extensions

Gratitude exercise: Ask students if they have ever had a negative experience that they were later able to find some good in. Ask the group things they can say to themselves to look at a situation differently.

References

- Kabat-Zinn, J. 1990. *Full catastrophe living: the program of the Stress Reduction Clinic at the University of Massachusetts Medical Center*, New York: Dell Publishing.
- Kabat-Zinn, J., Massion, A. O., Kristeller, J., Peterson, L. G., Fletcher, K. E., & Pbert, L. (1992). Effectiveness of a meditation-based stress reduction program in the treatment of anxiety disorders. *American Journal of Psychiatry*, 149, 936–943.

Super Powers

Outcomes

Students will be expected to:

- 9.1 analyze their health needs in times of change and apply strategies that enhance their capacity to manage change in their lives.

Topic

Life skills, resilience, seeking help.

Materials

- Pieces of paper with “villains” on them (see appendix)
- Pieces of paper with “super powers” on them (see appendix)

Background

- Arrange chairs in a circle.
- Explain the activity to one student prior to the activity and ask him/her to volunteer first.
- Place “villains” in a large circle and “super powers” in a larger circle around it.

Activity

Check in: If you could have one super power, what would it be?

Explain that we’re worried students moving into high school could succumb to certain pressures (villains), but that they may have some protective strategies (super powers) to help them fight back.

Ask a student explain each of the villains.

Explain that prescription drugs are medicine. Doctors give them to patients who are sick or injured. If you’re not sick or injured and take a prescription drug it can hurt you. A drug can lead to a dependence or addiction, it can make you sick or increase your chances of an injury, and in some cases it can kill you. They’re especially harmful when mixed with other drugs, like alcohol. If you’re taking them because you’re sad or upset there are healthier ways to deal with those feelings.

Ask for a volunteer to walk two laps inside the circle; one to list the villains they think they’ll face and the next to list the super powers they have already or will need to develop to help.

Repeat using a new volunteer until several people have had a turn.

Super Powers

Discussion

- Which super villain is the toughest and which super power is the most important?
- What can you do to build some of these super powers if you don't have them already?
- Are there any other super powers or super villains that belong in this list?
- What can prevent someone from using a super power?
- How can you make sure you know your super powers and the appropriate time to use them?

Check out: How did this session make you feel?

Extensions

- Ask students to write scenarios using the super powers and villains. e.g. "A boy was abusing alcohol but was able to ask for help and overcome it because he had close ties to his family." Encourage them to be creative.
- Have students who didn't volunteer write their superpowers from the activity and how these will be protective for them.

The Brolympics

Outcomes

9.15 examine the negative impact of stereotyping and stigma on help-seeking behaviour.

Topic

Stereotypes of masculinity

Materials

- Loose-leaf paper and pens/pencils for every student
- 1 children's story book
- 1 sheet of paper for every group member
- Tape
- A different coloured pen/marker for each student
- Prizes

Background

- Arrange chairs into a circle.
- Have desks or surfaces available elsewhere for students to write on.

Activity

Begin by explaining that the “Brolympics” is a set of competitions that guys around the world should be striving to excel in and that it is considered very prestigious to win a gold medal (prize) in any one of them.

The Brolympics consists of up to six events and everyone who wants to can compete in each one.

Longest hug: Students hug gently and the last two still hugging win team gold. Students can be disqualified for unnecessary roughness. Ties can be broken by adding back patting to the hug and/or judging the most tender group.

Best story-telling voice: Students take turns reading the same page (or short set of pages) from a children's book as if reading it to their own son or daughter. Participants are judged on the volume and speed of their story-telling, the voices they imitate and the emotion in their voice. This can be voted on by the group but the facilitator plays final judge.

Most poetic about a flower: Students are given several minutes to write a po-

The Brolympics

em or poetic thought about a flower. They read these one at a time and, as above, they are voted on by the group but the facilitator has final say.

Best complemter: Each student is given a marker/pen of a different colour and has a piece of paper taped to his back. Students should spend several minutes writing compliments on the back of others until each member has written one for all others. Spend a few minutes to decide on which compliment is best, taking into consideration the depth of the compliment (e.g. “You make me feel at ease” being deeper than “I like your sneakers.”) and report this to the facilitator. The student who receives the most votes wins. Students can take these sheets home to keep after the event.

Best apology: Students apologize for an unspecified wrong against the facilitator. They are judged on their perceived sincerity, emotional reactions and shows of empathy. Apologies are voted on by the group and, as above, the facilitator is the final judge.

Best “back pocket person”: One volunteer is given a problem to portray but is not allowed to directly say what it is. One at a time students questions and get one guess at what’s wrong; finally recommending what the volunteer could do to get help. The student who can assess the situation and recommend help in the fewest number of questions wins.

Extensions

- Discuss whether defying masculine stereotypes makes the students feel about themselves.
- Have students suggest other events for the Brolympics, or events for the “Girlympics.”

Closing

Notes

Effort should be made to acknowledge students are leaving this group as different people compared to when they came in, having experienced a rite of passage of sorts.

Note: It is recommended that the group end with a full session to close, after all other activities are finished.

Materials

- Cans/weights and backpack from 'Expectations of Men' activity; 1 weight for each person participating
- Blank pieces of paper and markers, enough for 1 each

Activity

Check in: What is one memory you have and one lesson you value from this group?

Place the backpack, full of the cans, in the centre of the circle and ask students to guess what it is that is contained in there. Answer "no" until they are listing the expectations of men from the earlier activity. Ask them to close their eyes and spend 2 minutes breathing deeply and thinking about how these expectations affect them.

Distribute the pieces of paper and markers, asking students to write a positive expectation or something they want to be like on the page; knowing that they do not need to share these.

Explain that the next part of this session will be a ceremony to show that the students are starting to shed these expectations and take control of their own lives.

Students should line up along a wall and the student at 1 end should start to unpack the backpack; passing the cans/weights down the line. When everyone has one explain that now the expectations are being held by everyone; each person taking part of the load.

After standing and considering this in silence for a short time each student should get their paper in one hand and can/weight in the other to come forward, in order from 1 end to the other, and place their can/weight next to/ outside the backpack. On the way back to the line they should place their paper in the backpack.

Closing

Explain as this takes place that the traditional expectations are being rejected and new ones are being chosen.

Students should line up all facing the same direction quietly.

Explain that students should take on the weight of the new backpack, consider carefully how it feels compared to the original for as long as they would like, and then pass it slowly along to the next person in line by putting it on them.

A facilitator should start, modelling the reflective time with the backpack on and then placing the backpack on the person in front of them. The last one should go back to a facilitator who then places the backpack in the centre of the circle.

Students are then called back into a circle as they have finished the ceremony; having shown the positive expectations that they each are now putting on each other going forward.

Limited follow-up about the ceremony may take place in the circle but is not necessary.

This is a good opportunity to bring together the whole class to let them know that as they go off into the world together, out of these groups, they still have each other.

Suggested supplemental activities are listed in 'Extensions' if time allows.

As students leave an effort should be made to recognize each one of them (handshakes, high fives, eye contact, etc.)

Extensions

If time allows for a celebration suggested activities include:

- Pizza party
- Card game
- Watching a short movie or TV show
- Going on a walk outdoors
- Games in the gym

Assessment

This curriculum was designed assuming the class would be split into gender-specific groups in alternating classes. Here are some project and assessment ideas for the whole class.

Reflections

You could track students' learning by encouraging reflection in the classes between activities. Here are some suggestions for keeping a record of their changing perspectives:

- Journals – students could reflect on the previous activity, offer feedback for the facilitator(s) and describe their initial impressions of the upcoming topic. Students could also keep a record of the anti-anxiety techniques they've tried and any progress they've noticed.
- Discussion forum – students could participate in an online discussion form through the class' Moodle site. You could offer guiding questions or have the students participate in an open discussion. This could help you track the progress of quieter students. It could also give students an opportunity to revisit any comments that were made during the activity.
- Website – This would be similar to the discussion forum but could allow more flexibility for student input. Students could conduct pre- and post-activity interviews on topics such as the expectations of men and women or consent and upload the results as a record of their progress.

Encourage students to relate their experience to as many activities as possible, not necessarily the most recent. The more connections they develop, the better you can assess their application of the material.

Media Critiques

Mass media enforces the pressures of masculinity and femininity. Students could collect video and image advertisements and determine “what's really being sold.” Students could have time between activities to add to their collections and discuss the rationale behind and effects of media that perpetuate exaggerated stereotypes.

As students develop an interest in the project, they could look at more specific issues such as:

- How food is marketed to men vs. women
- What's advertised where (whether certain products or types of products are advertised only in certain neighbourhoods.)
- Whether alcohol advertisements appeal more to teenagers than adults

Students could complete the assignment by creating their own advertisements. They could create “honest” advertising that represents more nuanced representations of people, satirical advertising that is upfront about its reductive representation, etc. The project would be a record of how they're applying the concepts discussed in class.

Assessment

Community Resource Board

Set-up a community resource board/wall in the classroom for students to contribute to as they engage with the Boys & Girls Group material.

Ideas for this resource:

- Encourage students to add to the board at any time, with the expectation that they contribute a specified number of resources throughout the year.
- Encourage students to explore the community resources on the board, adding more information or commenting on the resource.
- After discussing a certain topic in the groups, ask students to find a related health resource and create a visual outlining this resource to be added to the board. Potential topics include alcohol or substance use, mental health, sexual health, violence, etc.
- Discuss which health supports are strong in your community and where there may be gaps in supporting some community health issues. Have students design a pamphlet or commercial for a new health resource that they feel the community would benefit from.
- Emphasize the health resources that are available in their own school community (or in the high school they will attend next year) and invite these key individuals to speak to the class.
- Talk about how they can access these resources and role play what they may expect when they visit or contact a community health resource.

Potential Outcomes

9.17 examine how people support healthy communities locally and globally, and take age appropriate action to support a community health issue of interest to them

9.20 identify school and community-based resources and health services available to assist themselves or a friend if help or information in the area of sexual health, mental health, alcohol and other substance use or gambling is needed, and practice how to make initial contact with such service/resource.

Physical Health Experiment

This assessment could follow the group activity on our bodies and how they age. You could have students design and carry out their own experiment to track how a minor change in their level of physical activity can affect their overall health. Students can select a type of physical activity that they will engage in for five minutes daily, over a month, and collect data to track changes and assess trends. You could give students

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freedom in their choice of exercise and means of data collection, or have all students participate in the same experiment.

Some ideas may be:

- Students take their resting heart rate and engage in physical activity (running on the spot, jumping jacks or squats) for five minutes. Students would then record their heart rate after exercise.
- Students select a repetitious exercise that challenges them (sit-up's, push-up's, burpees, planks) and track the number they can complete in a five minute period, with breaks if necessary.

After a month, have students graph their results (change in heart rate over time, number completed over time, etc.). Students will likely find there was a gradual increase in their ability/decrease in their heart rate as they progressed, despite the small amount of time dedicated to this activity. Challenges to setting aside this time should also be acknowledged and discussed.

You could extend this assessment to examine healthy eating habits and have students create personal plans/schedules for adapting their diets, emphasizing that even minor changes can have an effect. Set specific nutritional guidelines and challenge the students to design the 'tastiest' meal they can within this criteria. Have students pitch their meals to the class and vote on the meal they would like the most.

Potential Outcomes

9.4 assess level of physical activity to determine whether they are active enough to achieve health benefits and identify time in the day to increase physical activity in 5 to 10 minute periods.

9.5 create a plan that enhances their healthy eating practices and reflects on supportive environments and challenges to achieve these health eating practices.

Design Your Own Neighbourhood

This could be an on-going project for the class, which would enable them to assess their own community and apply what they learn from Healthy Living class in designing their own neighbourhood. Students would start by creating a map and taking an assessment of their own neighbourhood, tracking the types of businesses, food establishments, community resources and outdoor or indoor spaces for physical activity. They may want to compare this to a nearby neighbourhood as a means of assessing how conducive it is to physical activity and how healthy the area is.

Based on this assessment of what is healthy and what may need improvement in their community, let students know they will be designing their own healthy community over the semester as they engage with the curriculum. Students should draft an initial design of their community on a large piece of paper, which

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will allow for edits as they re-think initial choices as they progress in the semester.

Considerations to point out:

- Placement of businesses and outdoor spaces. Will you allow a liquor store, fast food?
- Do certain businesses, food establishments and design choices send a negative message about how healthy/safe/affluent a neighbourhood is?
- Are certain spaces in a neighbourhood associated with a particular gender? Is this what you want for your neighbourhood? Assess gendered spaces in their own neighbourhood
- Will you allow advertisements and billboards in your community? Will you limit what will be advertised?
- What health resources or supports should be available in a healthy neighbourhood?
- How can you encourage physical activity in different age groups (children, youth, and adults, elderly) through your design?

Toward the end of the year students could present or display their neighbourhoods for the rest of the class to consider. You may want to invite a community designer to consider the design choices and talk about the commonalities between all of the neighbourhoods.

Potential outcomes

9.17 examine how people support healthy communities locally and globally, and take age-appropriate action to support a community health issue of interest to them

9.22 examine how design and infrastructure of the school community and surrounding community enhances or creates barriers to physical activity among youth

9.23 investigate principles of and beliefs around financial health and demonstrate an awareness of the capacity for financial health to positively or negatively affect one's state of health

Simulated Future

This assessment could follow group activity on personal superpowers. Students could work through a simulated future based on their life goals. You could set this up as a long-term project that students revisit and develop on a weekly basis. There is also potential for extension activities from this assessment. Students reflections are an important aspect of this assessment, and you may want to have students complete journal

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entries with key questions after each phase of the simulation.

Here's how you could set up this assessment activity:

- Begin with a self-assessment survey to help students reflect on their goals. The questions could ask about their post-secondary plans, careers, families, expected income, etc.
- Collect these surveys so they can inform the direction of the simulation. You may also want to have students complete a post-survey at the end of the year to compare their choices.
- Have students research the career they're interested in pursuing, focusing on the realities of a career in this field, including the necessary schooling, cost of schooling and average salary. You may wish to incorporate job shadowing here.
- Give students "Your Future Packages." These can be based on the answers the students gave, but should have some differences. If students planned to start a family, you may want to give students a partner in the class whom they must make decisions with. The package could include: career choice and salary, student loans, insurance type, commute time, number of children. Students could represent this information on a poster, which they would complete as they progress through the year/scenarios they encounter.
- Each week add a new level to the simulation. These could be assessed through the students' simulation poster or journaling. You could do this through:
 - ⇒ Proposing life choices that each student must make based on their situation (e.g. Do you want to buy/rent a car or take a bus; Do you want to purchase a house or rent? Do you want to go on vacation?).
 - ⇒ Having students randomly draw scenarios or issues they encounter and determine their options and the solution that works best for them (e.g. you lose your job, you need dental surgery, your student loan get paid off, your car breaks down, you get a promotion, large tax return or taxes owed).

Extension activities:

- Questionnaires/interview an adult in their life about the topics they are exploring.
- Job-shadow someone who works in the field they're interested in to find out about the career, necessary education and steps they may need to take to prepare themselves for this goal.
- Explore course selection at the high school they're entering. Invite guidance councillors or current students to speak to the students about the courses.

Potential outcomes

9.23 investigate principles of and beliefs around financial health and demonstrate an awareness of the capacity for financial health to positively or negatively affect one's state of health

9.8 develop a plan to acquire the skills and credentials which will lead to their career goals